

ARTICLES

This is pen []

This is a pen []

This is apple. []

This is an apple []

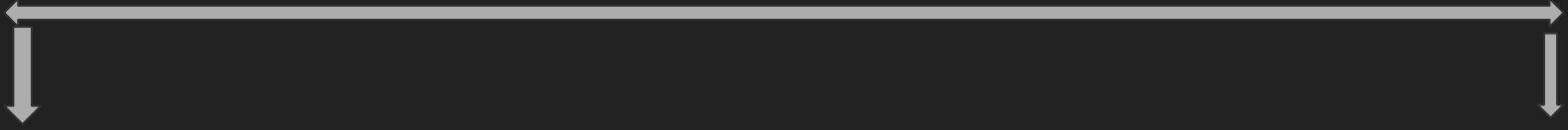
He is tall []

He is a tall. []

He is tall boy []

He is a tall boy []

ARTICLES



INDEFINITE

A, an

DEFINITE

The

A

Used before consonant sounds.

Eg: A boy, a European, a unit, a university, a union, a uniform, a user, a utility, a utensil, a uterus, a eulogy. [a speech given at a funeral] a euphemism [substitute] a one rupee note, a unicorn, a unique, a Utopia, a yard, a year, a useful, a UN, a ouija board. [wee-gee]. A eureka moment, a ewe, a eucalyptus, a once-in-a lifetime opportunity, a UFO, a URL, a U-turn

Use “a” or “an” before symptoms and minor illnesses

A toothache. , a headache , a cold , a cough , etc.

I have a toothache

He has a headache.

. She caught a cold.

He has a bad cough.

a sore throat I have a sore throat.

a stomach ache He has a stomach ache.

a backache She suffers from a backache.

a pain in my leg . I have a pain in my leg.

a rash He developed a rash.

A + Number + Singular Noun (used as adjective)

We use “a” (or “an”) before expressions of time, distance, weight, or quantity when they describe a single unit or amount — even if the word after the number is plural in meaning.

A + Number + Singular Noun (used as adjective)

a two-week holiday [one holiday lasting two weeks]

a three-day trip. [one trip of three days]

a five-minute break [one break of five minutes]

AN

Used before vowel sounds.

Eg: An apple, An hour, An heir, An honest man, An honour, an unusual, An MLA, An Urdu teacher. An historical etc.

An M.P

An HIV

An FM

An X- Ray

An FIR etc...

1' He is MLA from Karnataka

2. The bus lefthour ago.

3. I need ____ umbrella

4. It was ____ unforgettable experience.

5.He is ____ honest person.

6. We saw _____ heir to the royal family.

7. We visited _____ old European castle.

8.That's _____unusual painting.

9. We need ____ pencil to write.

10.It was ____ great performance.

The

Used to define a particular person or a thing.

Eg: The book you want is out of print.

The man who helped me yesterday was a doctor

To refer to something which has already been mentioned.

eg : She gave me a present. The present was very expensive.

Before a singular countable noun used as an example of a class.

Eg: The cow is a useful animal.

Only one in the world.

Eg: The moon, The sun, The sky, The earth, the world,

Musical instruments

Eg: The flute, The violin

He plays the violin.

But, to show possession, 'a' is used.

Eg: He has a violin.

Before ordinal numbers.

Eg: The first, The second

Before superlative degrees.

Eg: The tallest, The biggest

Before holy books. and classic texts.

Eg: The Bible, The Ramayana, The Quran

The Iliad

The Odyssey

The Canterbury Tales

The Arabian Nights

NB:

Book is referred to with its author's name, the is omitted.

Valmiki's the Rmayana (X)

Valmiki's Rmayana (V)

Before ocean. Sea,

Eg: The Indian ocean, The Atlantic ocean

Eg: The Arabian sea, The Mediterranean sea

, Mountain ranges, Before Group of islands(plural names)

Eg: The Himalayas, The Alps

Eg: The Andamans, The Maldives

To frame a noun from an adjective

The rich (rich people)

Before canal. Monuments , desert, river

Eg: The Suez canal

Eg: The Taj Mahal, The Victoria Memorial

Eg: The Sahara, The Thar

Eg: The Ganges, the Nile etc

Before the countries whose names starts with Republic, United,& Kingdom.

Eg: The republic of Ireland, the USA, The UAE , The kingdom of Magadha
etc..

Before well-known family names : the Gandhis, the Nehrus

Political parties :

the labour party, the Indian national congress

Inventions.

Eg: Marconi invented the radio.

Before name of a famous award.

I hope to get the Oscar award.

Tagore won the Nobel prize for literature in 1913.

When a proper noun is used as a common noun

Kalidasa is the Shakespeare of India

Kashmir is the Switzerland of India

Of the two.....the + Comparative

Of the two sisters Veena is the taller

We usually use “the” before a specific place

at the airport

I'll meet you at the airport.

at the station

The train is waiting at the station.

at the bus stop

She's waiting at the bus stop.

Omission of articles

Before proper nouns.

Eg: Delhi is the capital of India.

The Delhi (X)

The India (x)

School, college , Temple , mosque, church, hospital, market, etc.. are used for their primary purpose

We go to school / college (to learn)

Someone goes to church (to pray)

NB: I went to the school to see my friend.

Before material nouns and abstract noun when they are used for generalisation.

Eg: Gold is a precious metal.

Honesty is the best policy

Water is essential for human survival.

NB: The gold of Kolar is world famous

The coal of Jharia burns well

The honesty he showed me was unbelievable.

I drank **the water** you left on the table

When a plural noun is used for generalisation.

Eg: Birds fly in the sky. (V)

The birds can fly in the sky. (X)

The bird can fly in the sky. (V)

When man represents a race.

Eg: Man is mortal.

NB: But, for particular person:

Eg: The man whom I met yesterday was a doctor.

Before games.

Eg: We like to play football, cricket, hockey, etc...

NB: With a particular game:

India played well in the cricket match yesterday.

Before names of meals.

Eg: We have breakfast / lunch / dinner at usual time.

He enjoyed lunch with his friends

NB: Particular meal:

I enjoyed the breakfast she served me yesterday.

The dinner we had yesterday was delicious.

BEFORE

HEAVEN, HELL, NATURE , GOD, SPACE

She believes in heaven

Nb: The heaven of the ancient Greeks was Mount Olympus. [Particular]

He is afraid of hell.

She loves nature

NB: The nature of the problem is complex. [referring to a specific quality or aspect]

She prays to God

She loves nature

Space is vast.

The space between the walls is narrow. [referring to a specific area.]

REPETITION OF ARTICLES

When two or more nouns or adjectives refer to different persons or things, article is used before each Noun or Adjective

Eg : The Headmaster and the Secretary are coming.

Give me a red and a blue pencil.

When two or more nouns or adjectives refer to the same person or thing, article is used before the first Noun or Adjective

Eg : The Headmaster and Secretary is coming.

Give me a red and blue pencil

The + Comparative.... the + Comparative

Eg: The sooner , the better

The more you read, the better you write.

The harder he works, the more he earns.

Fill in the blanks using appropriate articles

1. _____ horse runs fast.
2. I saw _____ boy running in _____ street.
3. He can play _____ flute very well.
4. I saw _____ old man in _____ street.
5. All _____ boys were present.
6. He is _____ M. Phil.
7. _____ moon is shining in _____ sky.
8. Man is _____ rational being.
9. I have read _____ Arabian Nights.
10. Dawn is _____ English paper.
11. _____ whole milk was spilled.
12. He is _____ European boy.
13. _____ higher you go, _____ cooler it is.
14. We saw _____ snake in _____ grass.
15. _____ handle of this jug is durable.
16. He came here _____ hour ago.
17. _____ topic we are discussing, is very interesting.
18. She gave me _____ book.
19. He read _____ book I gave him.
20. _____ less you work, _____ less you gain.

1. She iselder of the two sisters.
2. The post office isnext to my house
3. Harold isEuropean
4. A word towise is sufficient
5. Smitha has got.....toothache
6. We will meet atairport
7.book on the table belongs to our teacher
8. When I saw him he was playingcricket.
9. Indian government is running.....two week campaign on foreign policy.
10. My cousin is.....last one standing in that row

- 11. She seems to beyoung lady with amicable manners.
- 12. Can you speakSpanish?
- 13. He is inhospital after the accident.
- 14. Ram went to park one day andpark had a pond with flowers.
- 15. Against her parents' wishes she wants to be journalist.
- 16. She promised me to return in hour.
- 17. Thomas is most intelligent student in the class.
- 18. The secretary has taken unanimous decision during crisis.
- 19. artist drew.....life sized portrait of Jawaharlal Nehru.
- 20. He saw SI of police sitting under eucalyptus tree.

21. ewe is a female sheep.
22. I am Indian by birth not European.
23. I met University student on way to buy Italian pizza.
24. She wanted Unicorn shaped toy.
25. I have terrible headache now as I could not sleep last night.'
26. I saw a man. man was standing in front of a gate.
27. Stephen Hawking has made innumerable studies regarding Universe.
28. MLA donated one lakh rupees from MLA account.
29. He is best actor I know.
30. This is the school for blind.

31. The train was going at 80 kmshour.
32. He ordered Cake and Eclair. cake was not good.
33.honest man is the noblest work of God.
34. Banyan is a kind of fig tree.
35. She is University player
36. Will you take ____ picture of us?
37. Mr. Bajaj Was.....very fastidious person who lived insmall house with.....beautiful garden.
38. I bought a penpen writes well
39. I only havehalf.....hour break to finish off my work.
40. The resolution was passed byunanimous decision.

Answers

1. She is**the**.....elder of the two sisters.
2. The post office is ...**x**.....next to my house
3. Harold is**a**.....European
4. A word to**the**.....wise is sufficient
5. Smitha has got...**a**.....toothache
6. We will meet at**the**.....airport
7. ...**The**.....book on the table belongs to our teacher
8. When I saw him he was playing**x**.....cricket.
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14. Ram went to**a**.... park one day and**the**.....park had a pond with**x**..... flowers.
15. Against her parents' wishes she wants to be**a**..... journalist.
16. She promised me to return in**an**..... hour.
17. Thomas is**the**..... most intelligent student in the class.
18. The secretary has taken**a**..... unanimous decision during**the**..... crisis.
19. ...**An**..... artist drew.....**a**.....life sized portrait of Jawaharlal Nehru.
20. He saw**an**..... SI of police sitting under**a**..... eucalyptus tree.

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. **an** Italian pizza.

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Universe.

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